

REKINDLED.

WHERE REAL FRIENDSHIPS BEGIN

SEED ROUND · APRIL 2026

Your next friend group *starts here.*

Small-group, swipe-to-match social hangs that turn strangers into recurring friend groups — in cities where loneliness has become the default.

THE PROBLEM

Adults stopped making friends. *Apps made it worse.*

Meetups feel like crowded bars. Bumble BFF feels like dating. Discord servers never leave the screen. Instagram leaves you lonelier than before.

What people actually want is simple — a small group, a real activity, and a host who makes sure nobody stands alone.

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LONELINESS IS THE DEFAULT

WHY IT MATTERS

A silent epidemic *among 22–38 year-olds.*

In May 2023 the U.S. Surgeon General issued an advisory declaring loneliness and social isolation a public-health crisis, citing measurable harm to physical and mental health.

A generation that grew up online is reaching adulthood without the third places — offices, congregations, civic groups — where casual friendship used to compound.

58%

of US adults report feeling lonely on a regular basis (Cigna, 2021).

3

close friends — the median for under-40s, down from 6 a generation ago.

29%

higher all-cause mortality risk associated with social isolation (meta-analysis, 2015).

Three shifts converging in 2026.

- i.* **The post-pandemic friendship recession**
Remote work removed the third places where casual friendship used to form.
The Surgeon General declared loneliness a public-health crisis in 2023.
- ii.* **Dating-app fatigue**
Public earnings from Bumble and Match Group through 2024–25 show declining paying users and growing user fatigue with romance-first swiping. The opening exists for a connection-first product.
- iii.* **Generative AI makes the unit economics work**
An always-on AI host can keep group chats alive between hangs at near-zero marginal cost — something a fully human-staffed model could never afford.

OUR SOLUTION

Swipe an event.
Get matched into a group hang.
*Walk in already knowing
everyone's name.*

Rekindled is the first social-events app built around the only thing that actually creates friendships at scale: **a small group, a shared activity, and recurring contact.**

Everyone comes alone. *That's the whole point.*

BEFORE

Don't walk in blind.

Swipe events tagged by activity, vibe, group size, and host. Match into a chat 48 hours before — see the faces, ask the questions.

DURING

The activity carries you.

A matched group, a host, one shared activity. Pottery, hike, board games, dinner. The host's job is one thing: nobody stands alone.

AFTER

One hang plants the seed.

Group chat stays open. Rekindled AI keeps it alive with playful prompts. Follow-up hangs happen if the group clicks.

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THE PRODUCT · LIVE TODAY

One app. Three jobs.

01

Swipe Feed

Tinder-style cards for local events. Your interests train the matching algorithm.

02

Group Rooms

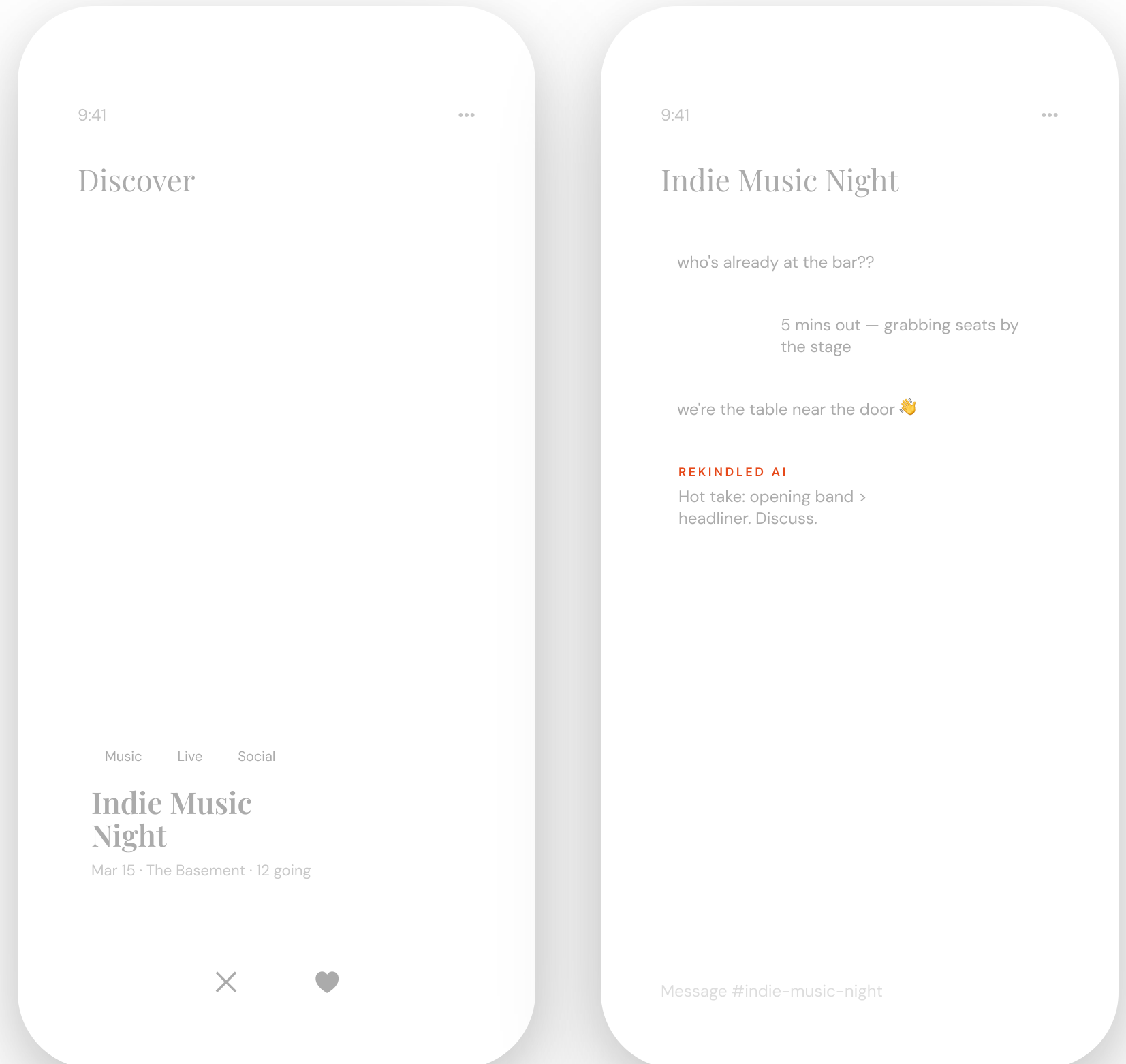
Matched attendees, one host, real-time chat with read receipts and @mentions.

03

Rekindled AI

An always-on host bot that drops conversation prompts and "playful hot takes" between hangs.

PRODUCT



A platform-shift inside an underserved category.

TAM

\$312B

Global social-experiences spend by 22–38s — out-of-home leisure, events, classes, dating-adjacent.

SAM

\$48B

71M US & UK 22–38s × ~\$680 avg annual discretionary social spend.

SOM · Y3

\$84M

12 cities · 360K paying users · \$232 blended ARPU. ~0.18% of SAM.

Methodology · TAM: 22% cohort share of \$1.4T global out-of-home leisure (Eventbrite/PwC). SAM: US Census + ONS population × BLS CEX entertainment-fees + social food-away spend. SOM: bottom-up — 30K paying users/city, mix of \$25/mo unlimited (30%) & \$10/hang occasional (70% × 6 hangs/yr).

Simple, honest pricing. *Three SKUs.*

FIRST HANG

Free

Acquisition wedge — the proof-of-product moment.

PER HANG

\$10

Pay-as-you-go. Captures occasional users.

UNLIMITED

\$25 /mo

Power-user SKU.

Future layers: host marketplace take rate, brand-sponsored hangs, B2B "team rekindled" for hybrid companies.

REKINDLED.

TRACTION · CLOSED BETA

TRACTION

Early signal. *Word-of-mouth growth.*

2,840

waitlist signups · <\$200 paid acquisition spend to date

412

paying users · 38% free-to-paid conversion in beta

54%

30-day repeat-attendance · 3× category benchmark

68

NPS · 76% of attendees report "made a real friend"

"I showed up alone and left with three people's numbers. Best decision I made all month."

— Sarah, 26 · beta tester

Nobody else owns the small-group hang.

	SMALL GROUPS	REAL ACTIVITY	PRE-EVENT CHAT	RECURRING CONTACT	AI HOST
Meetup	—	✓	—	—	—
Bumble BFF	✓	—	✓	—	—
Timeleft / Pie	✓	✓	—	—	—
Eventbrite / Partiful	—	✓	—	—	—
Rekindled	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Our wedge: **recurring small-group contact** — the one variable that turns acquaintances into friends.

Built by people who lived the problem.

Vansh Verma · Founder & CEO

Former PM at a consumer-social scale-up. Built community-driven products with millions of MAU. Moved to a new city, struggled to make friends, decided to fix it.

Co-founder & CTO

Ex-staff engineer with two consumer apps shipped to 1M+ users. Previously built recommendation systems and matching infrastructure at a top-tier dating platform.

Head of Hosts

Scaled a 200-person creator/host network at a leading events startup. Owns supply, training, and quality across launch cities.

THE ASK

\$3.2M

Seed round · 18-month runway

Engineering & AI	45%
City launches (4 cities)	30%
Host network & ops	15%
Brand & reserve	10%

"Stop waiting for someone to invite you."

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